This broth is filled with contrasting sweet, sour, hot, and salty flavors, and is made in minutes. Instead of chicken, you could try using fish stock and shelled shrimp.

hot and sour chicken broth

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 1 MONTH
AT THE END OF STEP 2

1 quart (1 liter) chicken stock
2in (5cm) piece ginger, sliced
8 lime leaves, shredded
5 garlic cloves, coarsely chopped
2 tbsp chopped cilantro stems
2 stalks lemongrass, split lengthwise and lightly bruised
salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 chicken breasts, about 4½oz (125g) each, cleaned and thinly shredded
2–3 bird's eye chiles, finely sliced
2 tsp sugar
3 small shallots, sliced
juice of 2 limes
3 tbsp Asian fish sauce
2 tbsp sweet chili sauce
2 small bok choy, coarsely chopped
handful of bean sprouts

1 Pour the chicken stock into a large pan and add the ginger, lime leaves, garlic, cilantro stems, and lemongrass. Season with salt and pepper, bring the stock to a boil, turn down the heat, and simmer for 10 minutes.

2 Strain the stock into a clean pan and stir in the chicken, chiles, sugar, shallots, lime juice, fish sauce, and chili sauce. Simmer for 4–5 minutes, until the chicken is cooked.

3 Add the bok choy and cook the broth for another minute. Stir in the bean sprouts and serve at once.